

THE DAILY FINANCE BRIEF

Financial News in Plain English

Wednesday, July 15, 2026

Edition No. 5

Personalised for Rishabh Srinivasan

MARKETS

U.S. Stock Markets Gain as Inflation Eases

On July 14, 2026, U.S. stock markets rose after the release of June's Consumer Price Index (CPI) data, which showed a 0.4% decrease in inflation from May. This drop was mainly due to a significant 5.7% decline in energy prices, including a notable 9.7% fall in gasoline prices. Year-over-year, inflation increased by 3.5% in June, down from 4.2% in May. The easing inflation has led to expecta-

tions that the Federal Reserve (the U.S. central bank that controls interest rates) will keep its interest rate steady at 3.50-3.75% in their upcoming meeting.

This news is important for everyday people as lower inflation can lead to more stable prices for goods and services, potentially making it easier for families to budget their expenses.

Source: Zacks

MARKETS

Cooling Inflation Boosts U.K. Stock Market

On July 14, 2026, the FTSE 100 index in Britain closed up 0.3% at 10,529.39, reversing earlier losses. The rise was driven by banking stocks, with Barclays and HSBC both increasing by 1.9%. This positive movement followed strong earnings reports from major U.S. banks, which improved investor confidence. Additionally, the recent U.S. inflation data contributed to a more optimistic market outlook.

This news is relevant for everyday people as it reflects the health of the economy and can impact job security and investment opportunities.

Source: London South East

Federal Reserve Chair Stresses Commitment to Low Inflation

On July 14, 2026, Federal Reserve Chair Kevin Warsh testified before the U.S. House Financial Services Committee, emphasizing that the Federal Reserve (the U.S. central bank that controls interest rates) has 'no tolerance' for high inflation. He assured that any changes to the Fed's policies would be communicated in advance. However, he did not provide specific guidance on future monetary policy moves.

This statement is significant for everyday people as it highlights the Fed's focus on maintaining price stability, which affects the cost of living and borrowing rates.

Source: KSL.com

June Inflation Data Indicates Prices Are Stabilizing

The Department of Labor reported that the Consumer Price Index (CPI) fell by 0.4% in June 2026, down from a 0.5% increase in May. This decrease was largely due to a significant drop in energy prices, including a 9.7% decline in gasoline prices. Year-over-year, the CPI increased by 3.5% in June, compared to 4.2% in May. The cooling inflation data suggests that the Federal Reserve (the U.S. central bank that controls interest rates) may keep interest rates steady in their upcoming meeting.

This information is important for everyday people as it can lead to more predictable prices and lower borrowing costs.

Source: Zacks

Major U.S. Banks Report Strong Earnings for Q2

On July 14, 2026, several major U.S. banks announced strong earnings for the second quarter of 2026. JPMorgan Chase reported earnings of \$6.14 per share, exceeding expectations of \$5.59. Bank of America reported earnings of \$1.21 per share, beating the forecast of \$1.13. Goldman Sachs also reported strong earnings, with \$20.98 per share, surpassing the estimate of \$14.47. These positive results were driven by increased fees from advising on deals and strong trading revenue.

This news is relevant for everyday people as it reflects the health of the banking sector, which can impact lending rates and financial services.

Source: Zacks

Morgan Stanley Set to Release Earnings Report

Morgan Stanley is scheduled to announce its second-quarter earnings on July 15, 2026. Analysts expect the company to report earnings of \$2.83 per share on revenue of \$19.45 billion. In the previous quarter, Morgan Stanley reported earnings of \$3.43 per share, exceeding analyst estimates. Positive sentiment from analysts suggests confidence in the company's performance.

This upcoming report is significant for everyday people as it can influence market trends and investor confidence.

Source: MarketBeat

What is the Consumer Price Index (CPI)?

The Consumer Price Index (CPI) is a measure that tracks the average change over time in the prices paid by consumers for a basket of goods and services. It is widely used as an indicator of inflation (the general rise in prices of goods and services over time). Recent reports indicated a 0.4% decrease in the CPI for June 2026, primarily due to a significant drop in energy prices. Understanding the CPI is essential for everyday people as it helps them gauge the cost of living and make informed financial decisions.

Source: Zacks

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